

Words That Do Two Jobs

A 5x5 board of polysemous English words with strong American connections. Each word has at least two distinct meanings — one tied to American culture (government, frontier, sport, military, enterprise) and one everyday sense. Green words are additions to fill the grid.

Proposed Grid

GREEN = added to complete the 5x5 layout

STAR	FLAG	DRAFT	VET	TRUST
SEAL	STATE	STRIKE	PIONEER	PRIVATE
BUSH	PARTY	BAND	RACE	LOBBY
TICKET	ACT	PARK	BAT	BILL
TRAIN	FRONTIER	MUSTANG	CHARGE	HOUSE

Word List

25 polysemous words, each with multiple meanings. The solver must figure out which sense applies to each connection.

STAR

- Celestial body in space
- Celebrity / famous person
- Hotel or restaurant rating
- Star on the American flag

+ FLAG

- Stars and Stripes / national emblem
- Signals for attention

DRAFT

- Military conscription
- Cold breeze indoors
- First version of a document

VET

- War veteran / former service member
- Animal doctor / veterinarian

TRUST

- Historic monopoly / business consolidation
- Belief in reliability
- Confidence in someone

SEAL

- Navy commando / special forces
- Emblem or emblematic device
- Closes or fastens shut
- Marine mammal

STATE

- Political territory / nation or province
- Condition or mode of being
- To declare or express

STRIKE

- Baseball out / three strikes
- Labor walkout / protest
- To hit or impact

PIONEER

- First settler in frontier territory
- Innovator / trailblazer

PRIVATE

- Military rank (lowest)
- Personal / not public
- Not shared with others

BUSH

- President / political dynasty
- Wild shrubland / wilderness
- Thick vegetation

PARTY

- Political faction or group
- Birthday celebration / social gathering
- Celebration or festivity

+ BAND

- Musical group / ensemble
- Striped ring or strip
- To bind or attach

RACE

- Speed competition / NASCAR
- Ethnic heritage or ancestry
- To compete in a race

LOBBY

- To influence lawmakers / advocacy
- Hotel entrance hall
- Large open space in a building

TICKET

- Election ballot / political slate
- Cinema or event pass
- A citation or fine

ACT

- Piece of legislation
- Theatre or movie performance
- To take action

PARK

- Central green space / urban park
- To put vehicle in gear and stop
- A recreational area

BAT

- Wooden stick used by batter
- Flying nocturnal mammal
- To take a turn batting

+ **BILL**

- Paper currency / money
- Proposed law / legislation
- A statement of charges

+ **TRAIN**

- Locomotive on rails
- To coach or teach / instruction
- A series of connected things

+ **FRONTIER**

- Edge of settled territory
- Cutting edge of a field
- Boundary between known and unknown

MUSTANG

- Ford car model / automotive
- Wild horse of the American West

+ **CHARGE**

- Military advance / cavalry charge
- Cost or fee / price
- To accuse formally
- Electrical charge

+ **HOUSE**

- Building to live in / dwelling
- Lower chamber of Congress
- Legislative body
- A household or family

Sample Connections

How words might link across the grid (horizontal and vertical). These are suggestions — the final verb pairs will be refined.

STAR — FLAG	The stars on the American flag
FLAG — DRAFT	A flag signals a breeze (draft = wind)
DRAFT — VET	A veteran of the draft

VET — TRUST	You trust your vet
SEAL — STATE	The official state seal
STATE — STRIKE	A state of strike (labor dispute)
STRIKE — PIONEER	Pioneer a strike (first to strike)
PIONEER — PRIVATE	A private pioneer (personal innovator)
BUSH — PARTY	A bush party (political event)
PARTY — BAND	A party band (musical group)
BAND — RACE	A band of racers
RACE — LOBBY	Race to lobby (political campaign)
TICKET — ACT	A ticket to act (performance pass)
ACT — PARK	An act of park (legislation for parkland)
PARK — BAT	Park the bat (baseball metaphor)
BAT — BILL	The bat bill (cost of equipment)
TRAIN — FRONTIER	A train to the frontier
FRONTIER — MUSTANG	A frontier mustang (wild horse)
MUSTANG — CHARGE	A mustang charge (cavalry advance)
CHARGE — HOUSE	Charge the house (political rally)